Revision Date:
April 1, 2026

Background:
Medi-Cal applicants may be eligible to immediate, conditional, temporary, no-cost, full scope benefits under the AE program if they meet the eligibility criteria.

Purpose:
This section has been updated to include guidance on the 12-month Continuous Eligibility (CE) protection period for children under 19 who are approved under AE on or after January 1, 2024.

Policy:
All new applicants must be screened for AE when an application is received with the required information. Applicants must be approved for AE if they are eligible to Modified Adjusted Gross Income (MAGI) based on their self-attested information but have pending eligibility verifications. Staff must follow up on any verification necessary to complete a final determination and ensure AE is terminated, when appropriate. This includes attempting to obtain a reasonable explanation to resolve income discrepancies. Refer to Medi-Cal Program Guide (MPG) 04.02 Application Procedures and 04.07.02S Reasonable Explanation for more information.

Adults
Adults 19 years of age and older who meet the AE criteria will be approved under aid code 8E. If the pending verifications are received and the applicant is determined MAGI Medi-Cal eligible, they are transitioned into a MAGI Medi-Cal aid code. Customers who are determined ineligible to MAGI Medi-Cal must be evaluated for other Medi-Cal programs and/or referred to Covered California.

AE is terminated when the final Medi-Cal determination is complete. If AE was granted in error due to incorrect/incomplete information, the error must be corrected as soon as it is discovered, and the eligibility re-evaluated.

Children
Children under 19 years of age are protected under CE for a 12-month period following the approval of AE and must not be terminated until their next annual renewal or when the child turns 19, whichever occurs first. Children are placed in the appropriate MAGI Medi-Cal aid code based on their age and self-attested income. Children must not be terminated during the CE period unless they meet any of the exceptions listed below:

- The child is no longer a California resident.
- A voluntary termination of eligibility (Note: The child would not be eligible for Covered California).
- Eligibility is granted based on agency error, fraud, or abuse.
- Child is deceased.

Children must be re-evaluated before they turn 19 years old. If they are found ineligible for MAGI Medi-Cal or any other Medi-Cal program they must be referred to Covered California with timely notice.

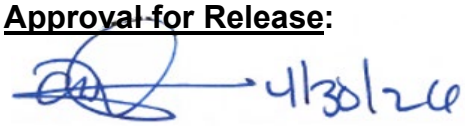
Procedures:
Refer to Medi-Cal Processing Guide 06 Accelerated Enrollment.

Automation:
The California Healthcare Eligibility, Enrollment, and Retention System (CalHEERS) is automated to:

- Place the individual in a Conditionally Eligible status while verification is pending.
- Post eligibility to the Medi-Cal Eligibility Data System (MEDS).
- Generate and send the Accelerated Enrollment Eligibility (NOD01) Notice of Action (NOA) to the customer. The NOA will also be available to view in the BenefitsCal portal.

References:
ACWDLs 02-36, 14-05, 21-32, 22-24, 24-03, 25-10
MEDILs 14-05, 14-61, 23-45, 23-55

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by March 31, 2029.

Approval for Release:


Alberto Banuelos, Ph.D., Interim Director
Self-Sufficiency Services